1.1 INTRODUCTION

Home Science or the science of managing a home, includes a study of all aspects related to our home. It is a study that focuses on family members and the achievement of satisfaction of each and every member through thoughtful effective and constructive use of resources.

Home Science is both an "art and science". This is because it teaches the art of using resources so that a harmonious whole someness is achieved and an overall pleasant effect is created. At the same time, it provides the scientific basis of techniques involved in making a home a happy healthy and beautiful place to live in. For example, the subject Home Science imparts knowledge about the different food groups, the nutrients present in them, the causes of nutrient deficiency and the dietary management of various diseases. This is the **'science'**. However, the ability to prepare various recipes with required nutrients for a particular age group and serve it in a very attractive manner in a pleasant environment so as to motivate consumption of healthy foods and feeling of wellbeing is an **'art'.**

Interdisciplinary Nature of Home Science

Home Science draws a major portion of its content from pure science disciplines such as physics, chemistry, biochemistry, physiology and biology. It also draws its content equally from economics, sociology, anthropology, psychology, community development, communication, media and technology. Hence, it is an interdisciplinary field with much scope as it encompasses the salient features and components of both science and arts courses.

1.2 EVOLUTION OF THE DISCIPLINE OF HOME SCIENCE

In India, the study of Home Science can be traced back to the British rule between 1920 and 1940. The rulers in that period introduced Home Science in some schools and colleges. It was initially known as "domestic science" and was first introduced in Maharani Girl's High School, Baroda. Later the Home Science subject was included in various other states such as Uttar Pradesh, Madhya Pradesh and some southern states and thus the curriculum underwent changes over the years.

Home Science has now been claimed to be an important subject in the school curriculum because it includes all significant areas of art and science which is crucial for the development of the individual, family and society.

Although Home Science paved its ways into many schools all over India it was not offered at the college level for a very long time. Hence, many students were unable to pursue the study of Home Science at an advanced level. Lady Irwin College, Delhi was the first to introduce Home Science as a degree programme at college level in 1932.From 1938 onwards, Chennai University offered Home Science at the degree level. Queen Mary's College and Women's Christian College at Chennai started Home Science in 1942. Since 1950, a degree programme in Home Science was included at Coimbatore (Tamil Nadu), Ludhiana (Punjab), Mumbai (Maharashtra), New Delhi, Udaipur (Rajasthan) and Tirupathi (Andhra Pradesh).

Under the leadership of Dr. Rajammal P. Devadass, Avinashilingam Homescience college has become a leading college in

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